

UL now ready to test and certify civilian drones in India

UL has announced the launch of its testing and certification services for civilian drone use. The services help manufacturers, importers, and assemblers to meet technical standards published and made mandatory by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), Ministry of Civil Aviation for Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS).

The new testing and certification services were introduced after the Quality Council of India granted provisional approval to UL as a certification

body under its Certification Scheme for RPAS – Provisional Approval System for Certification Bodies.

Flexible PCBs market likely to reach \$26.8 billion by 2025 end

The global flexible printed circuit boards (PCBs) market size is estimated to reach \$26.8 billion by the end of 2025. It is projected to grow at a CAGR of over 11.2 percent during the forecast period of 2019 to 2025, according to a new report by Million Insights. Increasing demand for the compact electronic devices is mainly boosting the growth of flexible PCBs. In addition, rising demand in the

telecom and IT sector, along with the high demand for high-speed data processing, is pushing the need for flexible circuits.

Pegatron, Tata Electronics, and others to invest in Tamil Nadu

Taiwan's Pegatron Corporation and Tata Electronics will invest separately in Tamil Nadu to make mobile phones and their parts. Tata Electronics will invest ₹57.63 billion for making mobile phone components while Pegatron will invest ₹11 billion to make mobile phones as part of its phase one investment as per a statement by the Tamil Nadu government.

CORPORATE NEWS snippets

Waaree and Ace collaborate to develop 23kWhr lithium batteries

Waaree Ess Pvt Ltd, an India-based lithium-ion batteries manufacturer located in Surat, in association with Ace (Action Construction Equipment) Ltd, has recently designed, developed, and supplied high-capacity 23kWhr lithium batteries for three-ton forklift applications. These forklifts, equipped with Waaree lithium batteries, have now been deployed at Chennai airport and are operating twelve hours a day.

Cavli Wireless starts making LPWAN, LTE, and 5G IoT modules in India

Cavli Wireless has partnered with GCT Semiconductor to license the chipsets and manufacture LPWAN, LTE, and 5G IoT modules in India. This collaboration will be the first-ever initiative to kick-start the manufacture of industry-grade LTE/LPWAN IoT modules in India. The smart IoT modules, based on GCT GDM7243i, come with integrated eSIM, GNSS, CAN controller, and BLE-4.2, for asset tracking and automotive solutions.

Triton Electric Vehicle signs MoU with BEL for EVs and energy storage

Triton Electric Vehicle has signed an MoU with Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) for developing electric vehicles and energy storage systems. As per the MoU, BEL will be the exclusive manufacturing partner to Triton in India for identified products. Triton will provide the know-how and technical documentation required for manufacturing of these products.

Infosys investing another \$1 million in UAV company IdeaForge

Infosys is investing an additional \$1 million in IdeaForge who is into manufacturing of drones and unmanned aerial vehicles. Infosys had earlier invested \$1.5 million in IdeaForge in the year 2016. The Indian Army had recently signed an approximately \$20 million contract for undisclosed quantities of a high-altitude variant of IdeaForge's Switch UAV, which will be delivered over a period of one year.

Amara Raja Batteries to set up 50MW solar power plant

Amara Raja Batteries Ltd (ARBL) is setting up a 50-megawatt solar power plant in Chittoor district of Andhra Pradesh at a total outlay of ₹2,200 million. As part of the overall lead procurement strategy, ARBL will set up a greenfield lead recycling unit with a capacity of 100,000 tons.

Amazon teams up with Foxconn subsidiary in India

Amazon has partnered with contract manufacturer Cloud Network Technology, a subsidiary of Taiwan based electronics firm Foxconn, to begin production of Amazon Fire TV Stick devices in Chennai. The facility will be able to produce hundreds of thousands of Fire TV Sticks every year. Ravi Shankar Prasad, minister for Communications, Electronics & Information Technology and Law & Justice, welcomed Amazon's decision to set up a manufacturing line in Chennai, as it will enhance domestic production capacities and create jobs as well.

Ampere Electric to invest ₹ 7,000 million to set up EV plant

Ampere Electric, the wholly owned electric mobility subsidiary of Greaves Cotton Ltd, has announced a phased investment potential of seven billion rupees over ten years to set up an e-mobility manufacturing plant in Ranipet, Tamil Nadu. An MoU to this effect was signed by the company recently with the government of Tamil Nadu.

Okinawa Autotech plans to invest in Rajasthan

Electric two-wheeler maker Okinawa Autotech plans to invest ₹ 1,500 million in setting up a new manufacturing unit in Rajasthan, as per a top company official. It will also bring out fresh products as it sets a target of selling 100,000 units in the next fiscal year, added the official.

Dixon signs deal to make Nokia mobiles in India

Padget Electronics, a subsidiary of Dixon Technologies, has signed a deal with HMD Global to make Nokia branded handsets in India. These Nokia smartphones will be manufactured in